Lipfty - How to play

Rules for Lipfty 15.0.12 | 11 October 2026

A two-player strategy game with shared pieces. Neither player owns a colour. Your opponent normally chooses the piece or colour you must use; you decide how to use it.

1. Board, pieces and setup

Use a standard 8 x 8 chess or draughts board. Only the central 6 x 6 is the playing area. The outside ring holds the reserve.

- 24 ordinary round pieces: 12 Red and 12 Blue.
- 8 shaped special pieces: 4 Opening Four pieces and 4 outer-corner pieces.
- Put the 24 ordinary pieces in any order on the six non-corner cells of each outside edge.
- At each physical board corner, stack two special pieces of the same colour. There are two Red stacks and two Blue stacks. The top pieces form the Opening Four; the bottom pieces stay locked outside.

Other clearly distinguishable colours can replace Red and Blue. Special pieces have a different shape to identify their role, not special chess movement. Choose a starter before play.

2. Opening Four

The other player chooses a top piece from an outside corner stack. The starter places it on any empty corner of the inner 6 x 6. Alternate players until all four inner corners are occupied.

The selected top piece can go to any empty inner corner; it need not go beside the stack it came from. Bottom pieces remain in their original outside corners.

When only one colour remains, fill the remaining inner corners with those pieces automatically. This includes two remaining pieces of the same colour, as well as the final single piece.

Opening Four pieces are pinned: they can never Move or Jump, and cannot be jumped over. Opening Four is setup only; it does not trigger the Accept / Take position choice.

3. Locked and released corners

Each inner corner has a matching physical outside corner immediately behind it. An Opening Four piece cannot count towards any win while that matching outside corner is locked, regardless of which stack supplied it.

When all six ordinary reserve pieces on an outside edge have been used, release BOTH outside special pieces at the ends of that edge. Clearing either adjoining edge releases a corner; there is no need to clear both.

- Both matching inner Opening Four pieces immediately become eligible for winning patterns.
- Released outside special pieces join the usable reserve and may be chosen and placed later.
- Inner Opening Four pieces remain pinned after release. A released outer piece, once placed inside, can Move or Jump like an ordinary piece.

4. First ordinary placement: Accept or Take position

After setup, the other player chooses an ordinary reserve piece for the starter. The starter places it on any empty inner square. The other player then decides:

- **Accept:** leave the first placement as it is and play the next turn. The starter normally chooses the next piece for you. Alternatively, accept by selecting an available outside piece yourself; that exact piece is yours to use on your next turn.
- **Take position:** take over the starter's position. Choose the next reserve piece for the original starter, who plays the next turn.

The first placed piece stays on its square in either case. No player takes ownership of a colour. In the app, click the flashing first placement for Take position, or an available outside piece for Accept and select. The labelled buttons remain available; the Accept button uses the normal starter-chooses route.

5. Game versions and winning

- **Learning:** Place only. Win with four pieces of one colour in a horizontal, vertical or diagonal line.
- **Easy:** Place, Move or Jump. The same four-in-a-row wins apply.
- **Standard:** Easy, plus four pieces of one colour at the corners of an axis-aligned square. A tight 2 x 2 square or a larger spaced square wins. The sides must be equal and parallel to the board edges; the spaces between its corners need not be empty.

Alternating-colour patterns do not win. A blocked Opening Four piece cannot be part of a winning pattern. The player who completes a winning pattern wins immediately, whatever colour it is. Check after every placement, Move, Jump and redeployment; a win ends play without further compulsory placements.

6. Your normal turn

Use the colour handed to you and choose an allowed action:

- **Place:** put the selected reserve piece on any empty square in the inner 6 x 6.
- **Move (Easy / Standard):** move an unpinned board piece of that colour one adjacent square in any of the eight directions into an empty square. Keep the reserve piece you were handed for the consequence below.
- **Jump (Easy / Standard):** jump an unpinned board piece of that colour over one adjacent, opposite-colour, unpinned piece into the empty square two spaces away, in the same direction. Remove the jumped piece for redeployment. Only one jump is made per action.

You cannot Move or Jump the exact piece the opponent just moved or jumped with while it is protected. After an ordinary placement, choose the next reserve piece for your opponent. A Move or Jump has the compulsory sequence below before normal play resumes.

7. After a Move

If the Move did not win:

1. Keep the originally handed reserve piece aside.
2. Your opponent chooses another available reserve piece and places it on any empty inner square. They may choose either colour. The piece you are holding is unavailable to them.
3. If that did not win, you place your originally handed piece on any empty inner square.
4. If there is still no winner, you choose a reserve piece for your opponent, who takes a normal turn.

These consequence actions are placements only. The moved piece is protected from immediate opponent movement during this sequence and their following normal turn.

8. After a Jump

If the Jump did not win, there are two pieces to place: the originally handed reserve piece and the removed, jumped piece. They are opposite colours.

1. Your opponent chooses either of those two pieces and places it on any empty inner square.
2. If that did not win, you place the other piece on any empty inner square.
3. If there is still no winner, you choose a reserve piece for your opponent, who takes a normal turn.

The jumped piece is redeployed, not permanently captured. Consequence actions are placements only. The jumping piece is protected from immediate opponent movement during this sequence and their following normal turn.

9. Endgame and clock

When the usable reserve has only one colour left, normal turns become Place only. Finish any Move or Jump consequence already under way first. Locked outer pieces are not usable reserve; clearing an edge may release further pieces.

If no usable reserve remains and there is no winner, the game is a draw. With the optional chess clock, a player whose time expires loses; the other player wins on time.

10. App cues and Undo

Available pieces pulse in their own colour; the chosen source flashes more strongly. Pale pieces are unavailable. Dots show legal destinations. Select a board piece for Move / Jump dots; select it again for placement. Steady highlights replace flashing when animations are off.

Undo, if enabled, restores the saved position and clock, even after a result, and reverses that result in statistics. Against the computer it returns to a human decision.

Play: https://blarm1959.github.io/Lipfty-App/